



10 Phrasal Verbs for Everyday Conversations

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About the Author



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In this PDF, I am going to show you **10 phrasal verbs** that you can use in everyday conversations.

I will show you them in context, in a simple conversation and then we will look at what each one means, one by one.

Here they are:

1. Be up to
2. Bump into
3. Get on
4. Stumble across
5. Figure out
6. Grapple with
7. Come up with
8. Have on
9. Wind up
10. Pull off

The Dialogue



Keith: Hi, **what are you up to?**

Tony: I'm great, I **bumped into** Jack the other day.

Keith: Oh yes, how's he **getting on?**

Tony: He's good but he said he had **stumbled across** a problem and he can't **figure out** what to do. He's been **grappling with** it for days, but can't **come up with** a solution.

Keith: What's the problem?

Tony: He doesn't know what to cook for his new date.

Keith: Are you **having me on?** That's easy.

Tony: No, I am not **winding you up**, he says he has no idea what to cook, and you know he's a terrible cook.

Keith: Well, tell him to just make a salad, I bet he can **pull that off!**

The 10 Phrasal Verbs



1. To be up to

To **be up to** = to do or be doing

a) What are you up to?

= *What are you doing?*

- I'm having a cup of tea
- Nothing much!

b) What are you up to?

= *How are you?*

- I'm fine
- I'm good thanks.

c) To be up to something

= *to do something you shouldn't be doing!*

- **What's he up to?**
- **He's up to** something
- **He's up to** no good

2. To bump into (someone)

To **bump into** = to meet someone by chance, without planning to meet them.

- I **bumped into** an old school friend the other day.

Pronunciation Tip:

With many phrasal verbs you can link the verb and the preposition

- bump_into / bʌmpɪntuː /
- bumped_into / bʌmptɪntuː /

3. To get on

To **get on** = to make progress with something

a) How are you **getting on?**

= *How are you doing?*

- I'm fine, thanks

b) How are you **getting on with your homework?**

= *Are you making progress?*

- I'm **getting on** fine
- I am not **getting on** very well with this problem.

4. To stumble across

To **stumble across** = to find by chance (to come across)

- I **stumbled across** my old notebooks from Primary school the other day, in the garage.

5. To figure out

To **figure out** = to find a solution (to work out a solution)

- I can't **figure out** what to do

Pronunciation Tip:

When 'figure' is followed by 'out' the /r/ sound becomes audible.

- figure_out /fɪɡərəʊt/
- I've got this new software and I just can't **figure out** how it works

6. To grapple with

To grapple with (something) = to try and solve a difficult problem.

- I started making a study plan yesterday, but it is so complicated, I am still **grappling with** it.

7. To come up with (an idea or solution)

To come up with = to suggest or to think of (a solution / an idea)

- She **came up with** some good ideas in that meeting.

8. To have (someone) on

To **have** s.o. **on** = to make someone believe something that is untrue, as a joke

- I'm not **having you on**, I really am a great cook!

The following phrases all have the same meaning as '**I'm having you on**'

- I'm pulling your leg
- I'm joking
- I'm teasing you
- I'm kidding you

9. To wind (someone) up

To **wind** s.o. **up** = to make someone believe something that is untrue, as a joke

- I am not **winding** you **up**, this is really true!

The following phrases all have the same meaning

- To wind s.o. up
- To have s.o. on
- To joke
- To tease
- to kid

10. To pull (something) off

To **pull** (something) **off** = to succeed in doing something difficult

- This is a really ambitious plan, but I think you can **pull it off**.

Grammar Tip:

When you substitute a noun with a pronoun in a phrasal verb, the pronoun always goes between the verb and the preposition.

- I can pull off this plan ✓
- I can pull off it ✗
- I can pull it off ✓

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